

What the public cannot check

Three gaps in the published record for Alberta's disability income assistance programs

On 2 July 2026 Alberta split its disability income assistance into two programs. Ten weeks later the figures that would let anyone describe what happened are not published. The last section says how to confirm every statement here, in about ten minutes.

The finding

Alberta's AISH caseload dataset was **updated on 3 September 2026**. The series it contains **ends at June 2026**, the last month before the split.

There is **no published ADAP caseload dataset**. A search of Alberta's open data catalogue for ADAP returns no matching datasets at all.

So as of 12 September 2026 there is **no public figure** for how many people are on AISH, how many are on ADAP, or how many moved between them.

1. The caseload

Alberta publishes a monthly AISH caseload series through its Open Government Program. The dataset page records that it was updated on 3 September 2026; the data file covers April 2008 to June 2026. June 2026 is the last full month before the programs separated. The dataset was refreshed two months after the split and still stops before it.

Searching the same catalogue for ADAP returns no matching datasets. Searching for Alberta Disability Assistance Program returns four, none of them a caseload for the new program: AISH Caseload, Income Support Caseload, Appeals Overview, and Office of the Public Guardian and Trustee Caseload.

The last published baseline. Anyone writing about the transition is working from these.

Measure, June 2026	Figure
AISH caseload, All Regions Total	80,172
Clients with employment participation income	12,466 (15.5 per cent of the caseload)
Clients with CPP(D) income	16,414

Source: AISH Caseload open dataset, Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services, updated 3 September 2026. The percentage is arithmetic on the two published figures.

2. What a person may earn, and the order that sets it

How much employment income a client may keep is not set in the regulation. It is delegated. Schedule 1, section 4(2) of AR 96/2026 reads:

“The Minister may, by order, determine (a) the employment and self-employment income amounts that a director must deduct when determining income, and (b) the method for determining additional employment and self-employment income amounts that a director must deduct when determining income.”

Section 4(3) adds that those amounts rise automatically with any increase in the hourly minimum wage. The amounts appear only in the policy manual and the benefit summary: **\$350** for a single AISH client, **\$700** for a single ADAP client, **\$1,100** for an ADAP client with dependants, **\$1,500** for a cohabiting partner. The order that sets them is not published with them.

The manual used to name the instrument. Versions of the Employment and Training Supports page dated before July 2026, which the site still carries, cite **“MO-2018-21 – Personal Benefit Rates and Frequencies”** in their authority block. The current version, dated 2 July 2026, cites the Act, the regulation and Schedule 3, and names no ministerial order at all.

3. The transition benefit amount and its end date

Schedule 3, section 13 of AR 96/2026 provides that a transition benefit may be provided, and sets neither the amount nor the end date. Section 12(3) provides that the amount of a personal benefit is determined by the Minister, and section 12(4) that the Minister may determine the frequency. So the \$200 and its December 2027 end are ministerial determinations, not regulation. The provisions are set out in full in the companion document, *Where the rules live*.

How to check all of this yourself

Step	What to do	What you should find
1	At open.alberta.ca/opendata, search ADAP, then Alberta Disability Assistance Program.	No matching datasets, then four datasets, none an ADAP caseload.
2	Open the AISH Caseload dataset page and its data file.	Updated 3 September 2026; data ends June 2026, All Regions Total 80,172.
3	Open AR 96/2026 at kings-printer.alberta.ca, Schedule 1 section 4(2).	The earnings amounts are delegated to a ministerial order.
4	Open the manual page for Employment and Training Supports and use its version selector.	Versions before July 2026 name MO-2018-21. The current one names no order.

What would resolve it

Publication of an ADAP caseload series alongside the AISH series, and publication of the ministerial order made under Schedule 1 section 4(2).

Source index

Every source below was opened at its own address on the access date shown. A source is marked primary where it is the issuing body's own published document. Nothing in either document rests on a secondary source.

Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped General Regulation, AR 96/2026

Issuing body	King's Printer for Alberta
Date of document	In force 2 July 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	kings-printer.alberta.ca/documents/Regs/2026_096.pdf
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. Sections 8(2), 8(3) and 8(4), living allowance amounts and the 88 per cent rate for cohabiting partners. Sections 12(3) and 12(4), personal benefit amounts and frequency determined by the Minister. Section 14, employment support types and frequency determined by the Minister. Schedule 1 section 4(2), employment and self-employment income deductions determined by ministerial order. Schedule 1 section 1(1)(e), treatment of the Canada Disability Benefit. Schedule 3 section 13, the transition benefit provision.

Disability Income Assistance Policy Manual: Living Allowance

Issuing body	Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services
Date of document	Page version 2 July 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	manuals.alberta.ca/dia-policy-manual/ (Benefits, Core Benefits, Living Allowance)
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. Published living allowance amounts including the cohabiting partner rates of \$1,708 and \$1,532 footnoted as 88 per cent. AISH rate history back to 1979. Authority citation.

Disability Income Assistance Policy Manual: Transition Benefit

Issuing body	Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services
Date of document	Page version 2 July 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	manuals.alberta.ca/dia-policy-manual/ (Benefits, Personal Benefits, Transition Benefit)
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. Rate of \$200.00 per month per client, and the stated availability period of August 2026 to December 2027. Exclusions. Authority citation.

Disability Income Assistance Policy Manual: Employment and Training Supports

Issuing body	Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services
Date of document	Page version 2 July 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	manuals.alberta.ca/dia-policy-manual/ (Benefits, Personal Benefits, Employment and Training Supports)
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. Rate of \$590.00 in a 12 month period, and the statement that AISH clients are not eligible. Earlier page versions carried on the same page, with their own rates and an authority citation naming Ministerial Order MO-2018-21, Personal Benefit Rates and Frequencies.

Disability Income Assistance Policy Manual: Rounding Benefits

Issuing body	Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services
Date of document	Page version 2 July 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	manuals.alberta.ca/dia-policy-manual/ (Benefits, Rounding Benefits)
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. The rounding policy and its stated intent, which explains the difference between the regulation's 88 per cent and the whole dollar amounts published in the manual.

AISH and ADAP Financial Benefits Summary

Issuing body	Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services
Date of document	Effective 2 July 2026; publication page updated 2 July 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	open.alberta.ca/publications/financial-benefits-summary-aish-adap
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. Living allowance table, the transition benefit footnote, the 88 per cent footnote, the \$590.00 employment and training supports line, and the earnings exemption figures.

Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) Caseload, open dataset

Issuing body	Alberta Assisted Living and Social Services
Date of document	Dataset updated 3 September 2026; series covers April 2008 to June 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	open.alberta.ca/opendata/assured-income-for-the-severely-handicapped-aish-caseload-alberta
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. June 2026 caseload of 80,172 for All Regions Total, 12,466 clients with employment participation income, and 16,414 clients with CPP(D) income. The date the series ends.

Open data catalogue searches

Issuing body	Government of Alberta Open Government Program
Date of document	Searches run 12 September 2026
Date accessed	12 September 2026
Address	open.alberta.ca/opendata (queries: “ADAP” and “Alberta Disability Assistance Program”)
Classification	Primary

What was taken from it. The query ADAP returns no matching datasets. The query Alberta Disability Assistance Program returns AISH Caseload, Income Support Caseload, Appeals Overview and Office of the Public Guardian and Trustee Caseload, and no ADAP caseload dataset.

A note on access, recorded for the campaign's own records

Two of the addresses above refuse automated retrieval. The King's Printer site and open.alberta.ca both block direct fetching, and a standing campaign note said the King's Printer could not be read at all by automated means. That note is wrong and is corrected here. Both sites are readable through a browser, and the text of their PDF documents can be extracted in the page. Regulations can therefore be verified directly rather than through secondary descriptions of them.